

Total Solar Eclipse Safety

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hgTMjMuRZWs
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary: Special Community Briefing on the 2024 Total Solar Eclipse

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

This section is omitted as the transcript contains a specialized community and emergency preparedness briefing rather than a formal municipal legislative hearing.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:00:12](#) The briefing session was opened by Delaware County Emergency Management Director John Coutinho to prepare the community for the total solar eclipse occurring on Monday, April 8, 2024.
- **Attendance:** Present speakers included local emergency management officials, law enforcement representatives, municipal administration, and local health experts. (Specific board member roll calls and absences were not part of this informational briefing transcript).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None recorded in this transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** None recorded in this transcript.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

(The transcript consists of informational briefings, emergency contingency planning reports, and public safety advisories regarding the April 8, 2024 total solar eclipse rather than formal legislative ordinances or board votes.)

- **00:00:12 Item: Delaware County Emergency Management Briefing**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Coutinho, Delaware County Emergency Management Director; Corey Kissick, Deputy Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Officials noted that Delaware County sits within a day's drive for 70% of the nation and is directly in the path of totality. Drawing lessons from the 2017 solar eclipse in Kentucky and Illinois where traffic congestion caused 5.5-hour trips to stretch to 17.5 hours and forced first responders to walk miles to patients due to gridlock officials warned of extreme traffic surges, delayed emergency response times, and potential utility or cellular network strains.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational briefing only; no formal board action or vote taken.
- **00:03:12 Item: Law Enforcement & Emergency Services Traffic and Safety Plan**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Deputy Jeff Stanley, Delaware County Sheriff's Office; Fred Cummings, Delaware County 911 Communications Center.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Law enforcement advised residents and visitors against pulling over on roadsides or private property to view the eclipse. Key high-congestion locations were identified, including Prairie Creek Reservoir, the Delaware County Fairgrounds, and local roadways. Officials stressed keeping vehicles gassed up, avoiding non-essential travel to maintain clear lanes for emergency vehicles, and anticipating 911 outages or long wait times due to cellular data surges.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational briefing only; no formal board action or vote taken.
- **00:04:08 Item: County Infrastructure & Transportation Coordination**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kyle Johnson, Delaware County Chief Information Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The CIO outlined primary traffic chokepoints, including the Interstate 69 corridor, state roads, and areas surrounding community events (Prairie Creek Reservoir, Fairgrounds, Academy of Model Aeronautics, Minnetrista, and school campuses). Residents were advised to utilize INDOT's traffic-wise mobile app or 511IN.org for live traffic updates and to follow the strategy: "Arrive early, stay late, and stay put."
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational briefing only; no formal board action or vote taken.
- **00:04:58 Item: City of Muncie Community Events & Weekend Schedule**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Municipal / Destination Muncie Representative.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Muncie anticipated between 100,000 and 200,000 visitors over the eclipse weekend. Residents were encouraged to utilize neighborhood parks rather than driving on Monday afternoon. A full schedule of weekend activities was highlighted, including First Thursday downtown events, Minnetrista museum and gardens activities, a children's museum exhibit, a brewfest and music festival at Cornerstone Center for the Arts, makers' markets at Canan Commons and Hartland Hall, and an Orchestra Indiana concert at Minnetrista broadcasted via Ball State PBS. Safety glasses distribution locations (Ball State, Muncie Libraries, and partners) were noted alongside information portal EclipseMuncie.com.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational briefing only; no formal board action or vote taken.
- **00:07:47 Item: Medical & Eye Safety Briefing**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Jeremy Gard.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Gard detailed the clinical parameters of the eclipse, noting that Muncie would experience approximately 3.5 minutes of totality starting after 3:00 PM on April 8. He emphasized that it is *never* safe to view the sun unprotected except during the exact window of totality. Approved eye protection must meet ISO 12312-2 standards. Unprotected viewing risks conditions such as photokeratopathy (sunburn of the cornea) and permanent solar retinopathy. Young children and individuals who have undergone cataract surgery are at heightened risk. Indirect viewing methods (such as using a colander or pinhole projector) were also recommended.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational briefing only; no formal board action or vote taken.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No open floor citizen forum or general public comment period was held during this specialized administrative and emergency briefing transcript.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Officials reiterated key community slogans for the event: pack a "five-gallon bucket of patience," treat the event like a "Super Bowl without a stadium," and utilize official planning channels at EclipseMuncie.com and 511IN.org.
- **Adjournment:** The transcript concludes with final safety reminders from presenters; no formal meeting adjournment time or roll call was recorded.